

The Art of Meditating on the Word of God

All right, since we are studying on meditating, let us back up and cover a few things. We have no big hurry tonight. Let us cover a few things we reviewed.

We covered points one and two, and we found out a few things. When God sent these letters, these chapters, and these books, He sent them in the form of chapters. Even better than that, Jesus, whenever He taught on a subject, taught a total thought. He had a subject to arrive at, and He taught it.

When we get into the Word of God, sometimes we take Scriptures out, and they are part of a total thought. Then we use those Scriptures to form doctrines or to base our own personal beliefs on.

A lot of us dig into Scripture, and all denominations are guilty of this. God forbid that we do not steer clear of that trap. We dig in and take our experiences, which are not worked by the Word, and dig until we find Scriptures to back up our experiences, instead of demanding that our experiences line up with the Word.

A lot of us get caught in that trap. We say, "Well, it is Scripture."

Yes, but a Scripture is one part of a total thought.

Jesus said, "I receive what I receive from My Father, and therefore I deliver it to you." When Jesus received from His Father, He received what we call revelation knowledge. In other words, whatever He spoke was revealed to Him by the Holy Spirit.

Matthew, Mark, Luke, John, and Paul, called out in due season, delivered the revelation of Jesus Christ from the Old Testament, from Genesis clear through to the New Testament and all the way to the book of Revelation. It is called revelation knowledge.

These men were called of God, and the Holy Spirit, moving through their spirits, brought this out and recorded what was given to Jesus.

This is very interesting, because these men had what we call revelation knowledge. That is what is recorded in these books.

The reason He said the Holy Spirit is sent to guide you into all truth is because the truth in here was given by the Holy Spirit, and it can only be given back by the Holy Spirit. The carnal mind can figure, connive, and reason things away. But the Holy Spirit was given to you and me to lead us into all the teachings of Jesus, all the truth contained in this Word.

He gives to you and me what I call an art, because it is something that can be developed: the art of meditating in the Word of God.

Basically, meditating is when you give yourself to the Holy Spirit.

I know there are different ways to meditate, but we have learned an effective way. I get somewhere quiet enough, especially when I first begin, where I can lock every outside influence out. I lock my attention. At first I force myself, because my mind is more interested in other things. It is running, thinking, going wild.

I take authority over it, usually by praying in tongues for an hour or so. When I do, it causes a rest to come over me. It quiets my mind down, quiets my ears down, shuts my senses down, and makes me more alert to spiritual things.

Every one of us in here has the Holy Spirit dwelling on the inside of us. He is the Teacher. He will take what is in that chapter and reveal it to your spirit if you will spend time dwelling on it, locking your thoughts on it, rolling it over and over.

I have rolled a whole chapter as many as thirty to fifty times in one setting. I have read it as many as fifty times. I go over it, stop, pray in the Spirit, look at the whole chapter again, listen to my spirit, read it again, listen to my spirit, and pretty soon highlights in that chapter begin to formulate in my spirit.

In other words, I begin to catch glimpses of the total thought Jesus was trying to bring out in that chapter. And, brother, here is the part that is neat: when you get the total revelation, and that is a fancy name for knowledge revealed by the Holy Spirit, when you get the total revelation out of it, that is what works.

Oh man, He has told me some good stuff.

Were you in here when we went through Matthew 18? That curled your hair, did it not? Luke 17, various chapters God has opened up because we asked Him to.

Some of you ask, "God, why do I fail? Show me the quickest and best way to get into the best You have." Then when He shows us, some of you say, "Goodness, there must be an easier way than that."

You will just have to get the tapes to find out what is on that.

Hallelujah.

Let us start this breakdown here. When we get over to Luke 6, and I picked on that because you already know that chapter real well, I am going to break it down in teaching. I am going to ask you questions and guide you, because the Holy Spirit has taught me to do this.

We can leave you with one of the most precious gifts you have ever received in any service, in any church, anywhere: the ability to understand how to meditate by the Spirit of God and get what is in there out.

Boy, that is a precious, rare thing these days.

All right, start with Psalm 1:

Blessed is the man...

Right now I could just start out by saying, Goodness, how would you like to be called blessed by God?

Before I get too tongue-tied in this, we are going to read clear on down to the third verse in one total thought:

Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly,
nor standeth in the way of sinners,
nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful.
But his delight is in the law of the Lord;
and in His law doth he meditate day and night.
And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water,
that bringeth forth his fruit in his season;
his leaf also shall not wither;
and whatsoever he doeth shall prosper.

We are going to go slow. I am just going to comment through here on a few things and show you a few things after I read over this many, many times, meditating on it, asking God what was in there.

After going over it several times, praying in the Spirit and knowing what it said, I listened to my spirit in the car. I listened to my spirit in the office. Those thoughts rolled over my spirit, and I listened and listened and listened. Pretty soon these things began to open up to me.

Watch:

Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly.

Let us stop right there. If I am blessed by not walking in the counsel of the ungodly, then what do I do to get blessed?

That brings us to the third verse quickly:

But his delight is in the law of the Lord; and in His law doth he meditate day and night.

If I am not going to walk in the counsel of the ungodly, then where do I go? To the Word.

Boy, you are starting to see some things in here already.

If I go to the Word for my counsel, then whatever I receive from the Word of God in counsel causes me to be blessed, because I am not walking in the counsel of the ungodly. That means the Word of God works.

If I walk in the counsel of God, then where does that bring me?

And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water.

By the way, I got stuck right there in the first half of the third verse for a long time. Jesus said, "He that believeth on Me, as the Scripture hath said, out of his belly shall flow rivers of living water."

Who in the world are we planted in?

Did you notice He says, "as the Scripture has said"? Out of your belly shall flow these rivers. Your planting, boy, we could go on for hours right there on who we are planted in and how that works.

I am blessed if I do not walk in the counsel of the ungodly. Then what counsel do I walk in? My delight is in the Word of God, and I meditate in it day and night.

Stopping here for a minute, I know a lot of Scripture, but do you know what this suddenly brings to my spirit? It brings the parable of the sower. Down there He says the measure of the Word you measure out to use is what you are going to get. The breakdown is: the measure of the Word you measure out, spend time meditating in, and act on is what you are going to get, whether thirty, sixty, or a hundredfold.

Look at this:

He shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water,
that bringeth forth his fruit in his season;
his leaf also shall not wither;
and whatsoever he doeth shall prosper.

Some of you want prosperity. Whatsoever you do, you will prosper.

I am not going to stay in this chapter very long, but I would like to ask you a question. As you look at the third verse, what do you suppose it means when it says your leaf will not wither?

He said his leaf withers not, because he is planted by the rivers of water. If I am planted by a river, drought or anything else can come. I do not care. Jesus guaranteed me my leaves would not wither.

The thing I am after here thrills me. He says I am blessed.

Let us go back to the first verse for a minute:

Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly,
nor standeth in the way of sinners,
nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful.

I do not care what they tell you, Jesus said you are blessed by going and getting the counsel of the Word.

What does "nor standeth in the way of sinners" mean? It means being where they are and doing what they do.

What does "nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful" mean? That is to point your finger and condemn in scorn. It goes further than that: a vicious, outward, public attack of scorn.

There are two things we will not do, and then we will meditate in the Word day and night.

In the third verse, underline this. Jesus, teaching this by the Spirit of God, said if we meditate in the Word day and night and our counsel is in it, we will be like a tree planted by the water.

In any study we have ever done here at the Center on faith, you know all through the New Testament Jesus likened faith to a grain of mustard seed. He said the whole kingdom of God operates like a seed.

We have studied seeds, and I know this much: a tree comes from a seed, at least the one in the beginning did.

He said a man who meditates in the Word day in and day out would be like a tree planted by the water that would bring forth fruit in his season. He would.

Get this in your head. He likened us to a tree because all faith principles operate on the seed principle. All faith operates on the seed principle.

Why do you suppose He told Joshua to meditate day and night in the Word? He said so Joshua could observe to do all that was written there. In other words, the reason you meditate in the Word of God is so the Holy Spirit can build into your spirit the correct way for you to act on it.

Meditating creates a capacity for faith.

When I meditate in His Word and the Holy Spirit opens it up to me, I know how to act on it. And it is correct.

With this tree in your mind, let us go over to Luke 6.

For as long as I can remember, I have preached on the forty-seventh and forty-eighth verses here. I think ever since I was born again and God called me to preach, I have preached on the end of this chapter.

For the sake of meditation, we are going to go to the end of this chapter first. Then we will go back and go through different parts of it. I want to show you what God did to me, because I spent almost two years on this one chapter. I do not mean consistently. I returned to it about every two months and went through it again. Each time I could not believe my inner ears. I could not believe what the Spirit of God was saying to me.

Since we are talking about a tree, you and me as a tree, He said we would be like a tree planted by water. Our leaves will not fail. We will bring forth fruit in due season. Since He likened us to a tree, I know by heart there is a tree in this chapter.

Let us start in the forty-third verse:

For a good tree bringeth not forth corrupt fruit; neither doth a corrupt tree bring forth good fruit.

For every tree is known by his own fruit. For of thorns men do not gather figs, nor of a bramble bush gather they grapes.

A good man out of the good treasure of his heart bringeth forth that which is good; and an evil man out of the evil treasure of his heart bringeth forth that which is evil: for of the abundance of the heart his mouth speaketh.

Back to verse 43:

For a good tree bringeth not forth corrupt fruit; neither doth a corrupt tree bring forth good fruit.

He is saying here, and I will just throw this out there, that if you are growing thorns, it is because you planted them.

Oh boy, I know I said a mouthful.

How many of you have ever walked out when it was time to have the bills paid, time for a harvest, time for your body to get well? You walked out to your harvest place, reached up for a big old grape, and when you squeezed your finger on the grape, all of a sudden you came back with a pricked finger and said, "Oh my God, that is supposed to be a grapevine. What happened to my finger? Where did that thorn come from?"

Do not act surprised. You planted it.

"I just do not understand why I am failing."

You planted it.

He said the man who meditates in His Word day in and day out, to observe to do it, is like a man planted by a river. He will bear fruit in due season, not thorns.

If you are bearing thorns, it is because you planted them. I knew you would really love me for that.

We have not read the whole chapter yet, and I would like to read it with you about ten times before I started in on this. But for the sake of showing you, I read this chapter fifty times or something. I got down to this tree here, and it had always been a great mystery to me.

When I was meditating in real deep thought on this, my eyes fell on that tree, and the Holy Spirit rose up in me and said, "Son, I am going to ask you a question. If you can answer it, it will be the key to understanding this whole chapter."

He asked me, "Why do you suppose the tree is at the end of the chapter?"

I thought about it, and I did not know. So I sat there and listened to the Lord. Pretty soon the Holy Spirit spoke up on the inside of me and said, "Son, because that is the harvest. That tree is the end result. That tree is the product of what you planted through this whole chapter, all of these sayings. See, this tree is you."

Look at verse 44:

For every tree is known by his own fruit.

With your little pencil, here is the word you probably overlooked: his.

Do you get the hint yet who that is talking about?

In order for a tree to grow, it has to have been planted. He says every tree is known by his own fruit. He said, "Son, the reason this tree is at the end of this chapter is because My sayings are all through this chapter, and you are the end product of what you have done with these sayings."

He told me, "If you planted thorns, then do not be surprised when you reach up and grab hold of a thorn."

We could spend the rest of the night right here on that tree. But we have to get the subject out of this chapter.

With your pencils, write this down, especially in the parables of Jesus: all the parables have a subject. In other words, there is a revelation, a point, a subject. Every parable has a subject, and every parable has an objective. There is an object you are to arrive at.

When you are going through them, look first for the subject by the Spirit of God, and then meditate for the objective. Why did Jesus teach it?

The subject of the teaching might be the Word of God, a man, or a thing. But the objective is what that man, thing, or the Word is supposed to produce in your life.

In almost every parable, in fact about nineteen in the book of Matthew, Jesus said, "The kingdom of heaven is like," or "The kingdom of God is like." It is like a mustard seed. It is like children. It is like fish. It is like a treasure hidden in a field.

In every one, the subject might be the treasure hidden in a field. The objective is what the treasure is, how you get it out, and what it does for you when you do. The kingdom of God is like a pearl of great price. There is a subject and there is an objective.

In order to really unlock a chapter, first we have to look for the subject, because we want to realize what Jesus is teaching on and, secondarily, what He is trying to get over to us.

Especially in parables, and also in regular teaching, a man will come up and say something to Jesus, and Jesus responds to the man. The man had the subject, the problem, the need. The response of Jesus by the Spirit of God is what will work on your behalf if the circumstances are right. That is the objective: what does what He said to that man mean to me, and how can I apply it to my life?

We are going to find the subject of this chapter before we go any further.

Look at verse 46:

And why call ye Me, Lord, Lord, and do not the things which I say?

Then He summed the whole teaching up in verse 47:

Whosoever cometh to Me, and heareth My sayings, and doeth them, I will show you to whom he is like:

He is like a man which built an house, and digged deep, and laid the foundation on a rock: and when the flood arose, the stream beat vehemently upon that house, and could not shake it:

for it was founded upon a rock.

The rock it was founded on was not only hearing Jesus' sayings, but doing them.

What is the subject of this chapter? The subject is not only hearing, but doing. That is the key to unlocking the whole rest of the chapter.

What is the objective? The objective is this: a man who does the words arrives at a house that cannot be shaken. It does not matter how bad the storm looks. It does not matter how bad the circumstances look. You are the tree planted by the water. The objective is that your house will never, never, never go down the river.

Boy, now that is quite an object.

First of all, I preached on this. I preached doing Jesus' sayings: walking on water, dividing the fish and loaves, calming the storm, raising the dead. Those were doing Jesus' sayings. That is what I preached on all the time.

One day the Lord spoke to me and said, "Why do you not get into the chapter and find out what My sayings are if you really do not want to fail?"

I would have rather gone back to raising the dead, dividing fish and loaves, and walking on water.

Let us skip across the page to verse 27 and read the first four words:

But I say unto you...

He said not only to hear but to do My sayings. Here is the first saying:

But I say unto you which hear, Love your enemies...

I would rather raise the dead.

Oh, goodness.

The next step the Lord showed me was this. I said, "All right, You said he digged deep and laid the foundation. Digged deep, digged deep. What have You got in there for me? Digged deep."

I asked the Lord, "What have You got? Digged deep?"

Then I pictured a guy out there with a pick. The Lord said, "That is right."

He asked, "What is the subject?"

I said, "Doing the Word. Hearing and doing."

He said, "All right, what do you think I mean when I said digged deep?"

I said, "Dig deep into the Word."

Why? So you would know how to act on it and build your house right on a rock.

Oh, goodness. This could get interesting.

Now that we have the subject and the objective, it will not be hard for you to break the whole chapter down.

What if you choose not to do good to them that hate you? What if you do not want to do the next one, "Unto him that smiteth thee on the one cheek offer also the other"? What if you do not want to bless them that curse you and pray for them that despitefully use you?

There probably are not ten of us in here that do.

Now you do not need to come up to me anymore and say, "How come I cannot get my prayers answered? How come my financial deal fell through? How come I am depressed all the time?"

We will help you. Praise God. We are all learning. There is a difference between being a student and being rebellious against the things of God. There is a difference between being taught and graduating step by step in discipline in the Word of God, and somebody fighting the Word of God with traditions.

If you are fighting the Word, you are in trouble.

What if I do not want to do these things?

Then we have the end of the chapter, verse 49:

But he that heareth, and doeth not, is like a man that without a foundation built an house upon the earth;
against which the stream did beat vehemently, and immediately it fell;
and the ruin of that house was great.

It is your choice. This is the thing about Jesus. He says, "If your hand offends you, cut it off." You are the one who cuts it off. In other words, you are the one who bears the correction.

He says if you are without chastisement, which means correction and instruction, you are bastards and not sons. But if you are chastised and stand corrected of God, then you are sons. What son does God receive that He does not correct and scourge? When you get off, He will correct you and get you back on if you are open and willing to be corrected by God.

You do not have to do these sayings. Of course you do not. You do not have to succeed either.

Let us look at this house. I meditated on this house. There are two kinds of men here, and we are going to examine both of them because some people get confused.

They say, "Brother Roberson, are you saying I will never have a test and never have a trial?"

No. What I am saying is that in the middle of anything the devil gets you into, you can win.

Even though you are a house built on the right foundation, it says the devil is going to send a storm against you. By every natural appearance, by looking at it, tasting it, touching it, my God, it looks like you are going under. There is no way you can help it. The stream is beating on the house. It looks like it is going to go.

But Jesus gave you His personal guarantee that no matter what it looks like, your house will not go down. The difference between you and somebody whose house did go down is that one of them is doing Jesus' sayings and the other one is not. If you had done them, your house would not have gone down.

In the chapter He says, "Judge not, and you shall not be judged." If your house goes down over everything you are doing, standing on the Word, it is because Satan was allowed to bring a judgment against your house that God did not check when you bound the devil.

It took me a while to face that, but I did. When I am failing, I do not have to look any farther than the end of my nose, and neither do you.

He said if you were planted by the waters, you are going to bring forth fruit in your season, and your leaves will not wither.

Now we will go back to that tree and find out about these thorns.

I spent a good deal of time on this tree, and it took me to Luke 17. Since we just finished teaching on that, Luke 17 says, "If ye had faith as a grain of mustard seed..."

What does that say to you?

Follow me closely, because I guarantee you, if you can learn to do this, it will change your life. Jesus never wasted any words when He said, "If ye had faith as a grain of mustard seed."

Men have made a mystery out of faith since the beginning of time. You say, "If I had more faith..." I said, "My God, if I just knew how faith works, I would be the most faithful guy in the world."

We have made such a mystery of it. It is a spiritual force, and everybody has a different answer: "Have more faith." You try to have it, and it does not work. Next time something works, you do not know why. You believe something this time, try it again, and fail. You ask everybody, and they say, "It was not God's time. He wants you to be sick a little longer. It is redemptive. You are supposed to be broke so you can be humble."

We divert to all these answers because it seems stupid. One time we pray and it works. Another time we pray and it does not.

The force that makes prayer work is faith. You are just talking if you do not have faith behind your prayers. Prayer does not make faith work. Faith makes prayer work.

Faith has been a big mystery in the Pentecostal world because we try to operate it. I know you ladies, you prayed heaven and hell together at times. At times you were walking on your tiptoes, bouncing on clouds. Everything you prayed for you got. Then all of a sudden you are praying the same prayers, and nothing is happening, and you wonder, "I must be doing it wrong. I just do not understand this faith."

Do you know what He said here? He said faith as a grain of mustard seed. That means faith acts like a seed. All the mystery that has been built around faith, all you have to do is take a mustard seed and study the phases that little thing goes through to produce fruit, and then you have the insight of God Himself on how faith works.

I thought, You dummy. All I have to do is take a seed, plant the thing, and watch it through the different phases, and I will know exactly, to the detail, how faith works.

Is it not interesting that He says a man who meditates day and night in the counsel of God is like a tree?

Your first meditations were always in seed form, your first planting. You were not a tree when you began. You were born of incorruptible seed, the Word of God. You started as a new creation, the perfect ground for every seed that would be sown in your life from that day forth.

If you say, "Brother, what if I do not want to love my enemies?" then every time you fight with them, you are planting bad seed. It is going to come to maturity like good seed, and that is where thorns and briars come from. You are going to be known by what grows out of a lifetime of saying.

Since He compared us to a tree in two different places, let us look at this tree again:

For a good tree bringeth not forth corrupt fruit; neither doth a corrupt tree bring forth good fruit.

For every tree is known by his own fruit.

If you have thorns, it is because you planted them or allowed them to be planted. You do not harvest grapes from thorns. The seeds got messed up somewhere. You planted the wrong ones.

Verse 45 says:

A good man out of the good treasure of his heart bringeth forth that which is good;
and an evil man out of the evil treasure of his heart bringeth forth that which is evil:
for of the abundance of the heart his mouth speaketh.

I do not know how to bring out the treasure of the heart any better than an illustration God gave me, so I will give it to you again.

Have you seen *Ali Baba and the Forty Thieves*? Those old boys ran out and looted caravans with camels. Some of those diamonds were this big around and this tall, with sapphires, rubies, great big things as big as baseballs, and crowns with jewels all over.

They walked up to this cave and said, "Open sesame." That thing opened up, and they did not need light bulbs in there. Why? Because those diamonds lit the whole walls of the cave up. You did not need electricity. There was treasure, diamonds, rocks, pearls stacked all over. It lit the whole cave. That was called a treasure house.

Do you realize what He is saying there? Out of the good treasures of a good man's heart.

You mean your spirit, your heart, is the treasure house that these good things come out of? Contained within your spirit are all the resources and riches needed for you to have come to pass what you say with your mouth?

You mean that is where the seed draws from, from the treasures within your spirit?

Jesus said it when He was teaching in Mark 11:23-24. He said if you say to the mountain, "Be removed," and doubt not in your heart, you will have what you say.

I used to look at the oil, the money situation, and everything else. But I found out that when the treasure house was in my spirit, I did not need to look any farther than what I was saying with my mouth to get my needs met.

He said out of the good treasures of a good man's heart, because your heart is the ground that everything you are doing grows out of.

As a man thinks in his heart, so is he. That is what you are. You are this year what you produced out of your heart last year, whether failure or success. Next year, you are going to be what you grew out of your treasure house this year.

No wonder Jesus said, "Doubt not in your heart." He called your spirit the place where all the resources and treasures are, all you would ever need to bring to pass what you are saying with your mouth.

If He called you and me a tree, and the tree came from a seed, let us look once again at this seed principle. I do not need to look any farther than a mustard seed and study the different phases of it to know how faith works.

Whenever I say something with my mouth and believe it with my heart, that is the planting of this tree.

My wife and the kids just got on to growing beans. I like to use beans as an example. She has them take a handful of beans and throw them in a little bowl of water, just enough to barely cover them. Those beans are real little.

You have to remember, I am studying faith.

Pretty soon those tiny little round beans swell up about three or four times their size, big, fat, puffed-up looking things. I say, "Is that not just like a baby Christian? They first get hold of the Word of God, and they just puff up."

Then I watched those seeds. They planted them, and I walked by them because that is what I am meditating in this thing. They got big, fat, and puffy. Pretty soon the neatest thing happened: this little bitty, finger-looking root came kicking out of there and stuck in the water.

At this stage, when that thing begins to grow, if you do not transplant it into soil, do you know what it will do? It will do like Christians who live on pure praise. They shoot up real fast and look real good for a while, but because there are no minerals mixed with the water, the plant will wither up, get waterlogged, fall over, and die.

But that little root comes out, and do you know what it is searching for? Ground. When it finds it, it plugs itself into the ground. The ground is what He was talking about when He said, "Out of the abundance of a good man's heart, good things come to pass."

That root is looking to stick into the treasure house, the powerhouse, the resources. Everything that little root needs is contained in that treasure house. It sticks itself into that ground and begins to draw the minerals out that will pop the image of what that seed is into existence.

That is the "doubting not in your heart." The Word of God carries the image of the seed you are speaking for.

If this is your image: "I believe according to the Word of God that Jesus bore my infirmities, carried my diseases, and by His stripes I was healed on January 1, 1979. I was, and that is the only thing I am going to say about it."

Then that seed is planted in your spirit. It is growing. The roots are taking root in your spirit, in the resource house, in the mineral house, in the treasure house, and it is going to draw out of your spirit to bring the image of the thing you are saying into existence.

Now can you begin to understand why He put the tree at the end of the chapter?

Psalm 1 says I am like a tree planted by the waters. Can you understand that those roots dug deep down into the soil, and that river always watered the roots so the tree had all the minerals and water it needed? It consistently, without fail, brought a harvest every due season.

That is me, and that is you, if the image we are planting in our spirit is the Word of God, meditating in it day and night, delighting ourselves in it, having nothing else in us. That is what is going to grow out.

This tree is at the end of Luke 6 because the tree is the product of what you did with Jesus' sayings.

A lot of you, and I know myself, I planted some things that should not be planted. I said some things. I stood and believed things that were not of the Word. I could not harvest, and they did not produce.

I used to preach ultra-holiness, and it produced that in my life. When I say ultra-holiness, I mean everybody got born again and then we were supposed to clean them up. I preached about people running away with the piano player and all that. Pretty soon you sow all that seed, and you produce that in your congregation.

That tree is at the end of this chapter because if you are growing brambles and thorns, it is because somewhere along here you did not do Jesus' sayings, and you planted them.

Jesus said, "Doubt not in your heart." You will have what you say.

Do you know why I do not do these things? Do you know why I do not do good to my enemies, do good to them that curse me and hate me, and pray for them? Because I am doubting in my heart that it will produce what it says it will for me.

That is why I fight with you. When you do me wrong and curse me, I do not forgive you. That is why if you ripped me off fifty thousand dollars, I will not loose you from it. That is why I go on warring with you. Because I doubt in my heart that I really believe it will produce what it says it will.

If I did not doubt it, then I would do it.

Now look at your planting. You know what kind of tree you are.

But I say unto you which hear, Love your enemies...

Which one of you is planting on that and continuing to plant?

I know. Let us go back to walking on water, raising the dead, and dividing fish and loaves.

Look at verse 31:

And as ye would that men should do to you, do ye also to them likewise.

In the light of the rest of this chapter, read that over and tell me why you think Jesus said that. You mean there is spiritual law involved there? Because you reap what you sow.

You mean Jesus did not just say this because we are supposed to be Christians and good people? We call this the golden rule. The United States adopted that. "As you would want people to do to you, do to them likewise." It sounds like a good gesture.

There is a false humility that enters here. People say, "Look how much I can take. I am supposed to be a meek little Christian and do good to people."

But there is spiritual law, and Jesus said this for a reason. He is still talking about the tree we are heading for at the end.

Whatever you want to harvest from men, sow. You will harvest.

Again, if the storm rises and beats on your house, and you said all the right things according to Mark 11:23-24, spoke to the problem, quoted good Scriptures over your body, "By His stripes I was healed. He bore my infirmities and carried my diseases," and then you still die, the reason is that somewhere along this line you walked in a part of the world that caused you to harvest that failure. You failed to correct it because you would not dig deep, meditate, and do what Jesus said to do.

He said this golden rule for a reason. There is spiritual law involved there. You will reap.

Let us carry this a little further. Go down to verse 37.

These are His sayings. He said you will fail if you do not do them.

Judge not, and ye shall not be judged:
condemn not, and ye shall not be condemned:
forgive, and ye shall be forgiven.

I do not know what I thought that meant. Maybe the judgment of the last day, that I would not be judged then. I did not really know until I was in deep meditation on it.

Then the Lord spoke up and said, "Go to the house."

I went over to the house. He said, "When the man's house falls, no matter what he tries to do to keep it up, it is because it is founded on sand."

The difference between these two guys is that the storm beat on both houses. The devil is going to throw storms at you. Yes, he is.

But if you are doing the Word and continue to do it, your house will not go down.

He said, "Judge not, and you will not be judged." I kept looking at that. I kept seeing people being mean to me because I was mean to them. Something along that line. The Lord finally jarred my thinking.

He said, "No, I am talking about spiritual judgment. Whenever you bring a judgment against somebody else, it is not righteous judgment, because you do not know the end from the beginning. You do not care about their welfare. You are putting them down to put yourself up."

The worse you can make somebody else look by judging them, the better you can usually make yourself look. You pick on other people's faults because it exalts you above them. It is self-righteousness: "I would not be the way they are." It always puts you one step above them.

He said, "Judge not, and you will not be judged." The judgment He is talking about is a spiritual judgment that is returned on you by Satan, and it causes your house to go down.

He also said, "Condemn not, and you will not be condemned. Forgive."

For judgment, I plant mercy. For condemnation, I plant love. For ought and strife, I continue to plant forgiveness.

Jesus said Satan comes to steal the Word. He is after the Word. All persecution and affliction arise for one reason and one reason alone: to choke the production of the Word of God before it can come to harvest and solve your problem.

The devil may line five hundred people up at your doorstep to judge you, condemn you, and bring ought and strife against you. If all the pressure they are bringing against you cannot move you off the rock into judgment, condemnation, strife, or fighting, then he has failed in what he attempted to do. He tried to cause you to open your mouth and sow your field with bad seed.

No matter how bad it looks, how badly they are doing you, how badly they persecute you, even if you are in the bottom of Siberia in a coal mine and they are dragging you out and persecuting you, if you refuse to move with the pressure of the devil, he cannot get you to open your mouth and sow the bad seed. That also comes to harvest.

He said you would be known by your fruit.

I have made up my mind. I am going to walk in love and walk in the fullness of this chapter and sow good seed. Because if I do not give the devil a foothold, he cannot harvest anything in me.

That is what Jesus meant when He said, "The prince of this world cometh, and hath nothing in Me." Never in Jesus' ministry did the devil ever gain any foothold by any pressure, persecution, affliction, or care. Even in the Garden of Gethsemane, He resisted the entry of that care until He cried out, "If it be possible, let this cup pass from Me." But in submission He said, "Not My will, but Yours be done."

The devil failed to get any foothold in Jesus' life. Therefore, he harvested nothing with Jesus.

In order for you to walk in that kind of faith, it is the simplest thing. It is not grunting. It is not praying a hard prayer. It is not praying all night long begging God. It is simply speaking the Word of God and walking in this chapter until you harvest it.

Can you imagine the position the devil is in if he cannot get you to plant? He gets smaller every day.

Hallelujah.

All I had to know was what to do.

Can you see how meditating in this whole chapter goes together? You are not supposed to pick simple Scriptures out of it. He had a reason for each one of these Scriptures He spoke. He was heading toward the ultimate goal: the harvest of your tree and a house that could not be shaken.

That was the whole teaching of this chapter, not for you to take verse 38 out of here and take offerings on it.

Let us find out what verse 38 really means in light of the whole chapter:

Give, and it shall be given unto you;

good measure, pressed down, and shaken together, and running over, shall men give into your bosom.

For with the same measure that ye mete withal it shall be measured to you again.

In other words, if you sow goodness, mercy, and justice for hate, cursing, and spiteful use, if you sow money, it includes that. If you sow mercy for judgment, love for condemnation, and forgiveness for ought, then the measure you sow and give out is the measure it is going to come

back on you.

It includes money. It includes the whole spectrum, the whole scope of this chapter. The measure I give out is what I am going to reap.

There is no prison in hell that can hold a man who can grow his way out of it.

You say, "What about Paul? He knew about the Word of God if anybody did."

One time Paul said he was between two opinions. Tradition says the ax was grinding behind the door, and he said, "I am between two opinions, whether to stay here or go home."

Would you think the jailers had the choice whether he left or not? He said, "I am between two opinions." He would rather go personally, but he said, "For your sakes, because you do not know the Word of God and the devil beats you up all the time, it is more expedient, or necessary, that I stay."

He decided to stay.

"Well, they are the ones who had him in jail."

No. That tickles me.

You know where he says, "Whatever state I am in, I have learned to be content"? Do you know what that really says? It says, "Whatever state I am in, I have found myself to be independent of circumstances."

A lot of people use the Scripture, "Precious in the sight of the Lord is the death of His saints." A guy gets killed at a young age, and someone says, "Precious in the sight of the Lord." It sounds like everybody preaches it at funerals as though God is glad you got killed.

Do you know what the Hebrew is on that? Costly. Costly in the sight of the Lord. In other words, He needs you.

I asked God, to sum this thing up, because then I got caught in the thought, "I am not going to judge anybody. I do not care what they are doing."

If you are going to jump off a cliff, I am not going to go up and say, "You should not jump off the cliff. You might get hurt." Judgments can go that far. Somebody may be running off with somebody else's wife, and you say something, and they say, "I am not going to judge the man because I do not know his heart."

I asked God, "Lord, where is the line?"

I said, "I would not sow a bad seed if You beat me to death with a broomstick. I am tired of harvesting failure. I am going to walk in this thing. I am going to walk in love and walk in the best You have, and no devil in hell is going to bring my house down. Everybody around me can walk in

whatever they want. This old boy has his shield up and his armor on. Whatever you do will not affect my walk. You cannot make me hate you. You cannot get me to despise you. I love you, and there is nothing you can do about it. It is for my self-survival as well as yours."

It says, "Pray one for another, that ye may be healed."

I asked Him, "When can I judge? Where do You draw the line?"

Then I got into this next one, verse 41:

And why beholdest thou the mote that is in thy brother's eye, but perceivest not the beam that is in thine own eye?

Either how canst thou say to thy brother, Brother, let me pull out the mote that is in thine eye,

when thou thyself beholdest not the beam that is in thine own eye?

Thou hypocrite, cast out first the beam out of thine own eye,

and then shalt thou see clearly to pull out the mote that is in thy brother's eye.

In other words, if I am in the same strife you are, if I am in the same boat and jump up there, I cannot help you get out of your problem because I am in the same one. If the blind lead the blind, we both fall in the ditch, and that is in here too.

If we are hashers and talkers, and most preachers are, it would make me sick. When I stepped out of the congregation and other preachers finally recognized me not as a mill hand, not as a chain puller, but as a minister, I went to a ministers' association dinner where all the preachers in town got together to have dinner and talk.

It took me three days to believe God for my finances again. I never heard anything that made me feel so sick in all my life. I thought, "Oh good, I do not want to come back."

I will be honest with you, folks. If you heard the way some of them talk about you when you are not there, you would not go back either.

I got disillusioned. I had sat in the congregation and listened to these guys and thought they were something else. I found out most of them were preaching it for you and not doing it themselves, and that is the worst shape you can be in.

He said, "You hypocrite." You cannot get the mote out of anybody else's eye when you are running around with one in your own.

I cannot help you when I am in strife. We end up blacking each other's eyes. The only way I can help you is if I am completely out of it. Then and only then will I see your problem. When I see your problem and I am completely out of strife, then I can deal with your problem and with you.

It does not matter what you do to me. You can stick your tongue out at me, call me ugly, fight me, strife with me, and I will not fight back. I will not respond, and therefore I can see clearly to get it out of your eye.

But if I am going to act any way like you are, then I cannot help you get it out, because I have one in my own.

I asked God, "All right, being a minister, I want to help the guy get the mote out of his eye. But You are going to have to show me how to get the beam out of my eye."

I meditated on this and said, "Lord, how do I get the beam out of my eye?"

He spoke up on the inside of me and said, "Back up and start with bless them that curse you. Pray for them. Do all of that up to this point. Then you have certainly extracted the beam out of your eye. At that point, you can help anybody get a little mote out of theirs."

Do you want to see the ultimate goal of this thing?

Verse 40 says:

The disciple is not above his master: but every one that is perfect shall be as his master.

I have a margin rendering here, and the Greek says, "shall be perfected as his master."

The disciple, that is a disciplined follower of the Word, is not above his master. Disciple means disciplined follower.

Jesus said:

If ye continue in My word, then are ye My disciples indeed;
And ye shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free.

Can you imagine what this is saying? The disciple is not above his master, but everyone who is perfected as his master shall be as his master.

Who is your Master?

Do you realize that when you walk perfected in the Word of God like this, you can walk just like Jesus?

Just like Jesus.

He was a tree. He was the root that sprang up from Jesse. He was the planting of God. He was the ax that was laid to the root. He was the rivers of living water that our roots grew into and our tree took root in.

He says everyone who is like Him, a disciplined follower of Jesus' words, as he does and conforms to Him, becomes just like Jesus.

Every planting that I plant in faith with my mouth, I will harvest. I will not have any thorns unless I plant them. And every storm against my house, as against Jesus' house, will not wash me away because I am founded on doing His sayings.